

Xuanbin Yang

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Last updated: September 2026

Research Interests

Empirical Asset Pricing; Time-Series Analysis; Nonparametric Statistics; Machine Learning.

Education

Nankai University, School of Finance

Sep 2022 – Present

Ph.D. in Finance (Financial Econometrics)

Advisor: Prof. Tingting Cheng.

Monash University, Monash Business School

Mar 2026 – Mar 2027

Visiting Ph.D. in Econometrics, Department of Econometrics and Business Statistics

Advisor: Prof. Jiti Gao. Funded by the China Scholarship Council.

Southwestern University of Finance and Economics, School of Finance

Sep 2018 – Jun 2022

Bachelor's Degree in Finance, Finance and Artificial Intelligence Experimental Program

GPA: 3.9/4.0; top 3%; Outstanding Graduate.

Research Papers

Published and Forthcoming

1. Economic policy uncertainty and municipal corporate bonds credit spreads: Evidence from China (*with Tingting Cheng, Liping Qiu, Wenya Lv, and Gang Yang*). ***Finance Research Letters***, 69, 106170, 2024.

Revise and Resubmit

2. Predicting the Predictable: Decomposing and Forecasting Stock Returns in a Data-rich Environment (*with Tingting Cheng and Albert Bo Zhao*). Resubmitted (First decision: Reject and Resubmit) to ***Management Science***.
3. Binary Response Forecasting under a Factor-Augmented Framework (*with Tingting Cheng, Jiachen Cong, and Fei Liu*). Reject and resubmit at ***Journal of Applied Econometrics***.
4. Market Expectations in the Cross-Section of Leading Present Values (*with Mengmeng Guo and Qihua Xu*). Major revision at ***Journal of Financial Econometrics***.

Under Review

5. Extracting Predictability: A Time-Varying Factor-Augmented Approach under Mixed Persistence (*with Tingting Cheng, Jiti Gao, and Yayi Yan*). Under review at ***Journal of Econometrics***.
6. Bootstrap Inference for Present-Value Models with Estimated Factors (*with Tingting Cheng*). Under review at ***Economics Letters***.
7. FISTRA: A Financial-Factor-Informed Set Transformer for Learning Tradable Factors from Stock Cross-Sections (*with Tingting Cheng, Fengli Ma, and Yue Zheng*). Under review at ***AAAI 2027***.

Research Grants and Fellowships

1. National Natural Science Foundation of China General Program (No. 72673089) Through Dec 2030
Theory and Applications of Nonlinear High-Dimensional Panel Data Models
Project participant. Principal investigator: Prof. Tingting Cheng.
2. China Scholarship Council Scholarship for Joint Ph.D. Training Mar 2026 – Mar 2027
Monash University, Australia
Recipient of a 12-month scholarship for visiting doctoral research in econometrics.
3. National Natural Science Foundation of China General Program (No. 72173068) Jan 2022 – Dec 2025
Theory and Applications of Varying-Coefficient Factor-Augmented Models in the Big-Data Era
Project participant. Principal investigator: Prof. Tingting Cheng.

Conference Presentations

All presentations listed below are oral; forthcoming presentations are marked as scheduled.

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| Oct 2026 | 23rd Chinese Finance Annual Meeting
<i>Nankai University, Tianjin, China. Scheduled.</i> |
| Oct 2026 | 23rd Annual Conference on Financial Systems Engineering and Risk Management
<i>Southwest Jiaotong University, Chengdu, China. Scheduled.</i> |
| Aug 2026 | 11th Forum on Risk Management and Financial Statistics
<i>Hebei University of Technology, Tianjin, China. Outstanding Paper Award.</i> |
| Aug 2026 | 9th International Conference on Econometrics and Statistics (EcoSta 2026)
<i>Ryukoku University, Kyoto, Japan</i> |
| Jul 2026 | 4th Joint Conference on Statistics and Data Science
<i>Guiyang, Guizhou, China</i> |
| Jun 2026 | International Workshop on Machine Learning and Applications in Financial Econometrics
<i>Southwestern University of Finance and Economics, Chengdu, China</i> |
| Dec 2025 | 6th Workshop on Big Data Econometrics: Theory and Applications — Econometric Modeling and Statistical Learning for Time Series Data
<i>Zhongnan University of Economics and Law, Wuhan, China</i> |
| Oct 2025 | 22nd Chinese Finance Annual Meeting
<i>Nanjing University, Nanjing, China</i> |
| Jul 2025 | 2025 International Conference on Econometrics and Statistics (ICES 2025)
<i>Harbin Institute of Technology, Harbin, China. Best Student Oral Presentation Award.</i> |
| Dec 2024 | 40th Anniversary Conference and 2024 Annual Meeting of the National Association of Industrial Statistics Teaching and Research
<i>Shanghai University of Finance and Economics, Shanghai, China</i> |
| Jul 2024 | International Workshop on Financial Econometrics: Applications and Practice
<i>Nankai University, Tianjin, China</i> |
| Jun 2024 | International Chinese Statistical Association (ICSA) 2024 China Conference
<i>Zhongnan University of Economics and Law, Wuhan, China</i> |
| May 2024 | 10th Jingshi Scholars Forum and 5th Tsinghua-Peking-Renmin Graduate Forum in Economics and Management
<i>Renmin University of China, Beijing, China</i> |
| Dec 2023 | National Academic Forum for Ph.D. Students in Quantitative Economics
<i>Xiamen University, Xiamen, China</i> |

Honors and Awards

- Gongneng Scholarship, Nankai University (four times).
- Outstanding Graduate; Outstanding Student, Southwestern University of Finance and Economics.
- Innovation and Entrepreneurship Scholarship; Labor Literacy and Skills Scholarship; Social Work and Volunteer Service Scholarship, Southwestern University of Finance and Economics.
- Honorable Mention, COMAP Mathematical Contest in Modeling.
- Provincial Second Prize, China Undergraduate Mathematical Contest in Modeling.
- Provincial First Prize, Sichuan Provincial College Student FinTech Modeling Competition.
- Provincial Third Prize, Chinese Mathematics Competitions.
- Sichuan Province A-Level Certificate for College Student Comprehensive Quality.

Professional Service and Skills

Referee service: ***Econometric Reviews***; ***Finance Research Letters***; ***Economic Modelling***.

Software: MATLAB; Python; R; Stata; L^AT_EX.